

A Theory of Multidimensional Sovereign Capability Convergence

Lord Soumadeep Ghosh with ChatGPT (OpenAI)

Kolkata, India

Abstract

This paper develops a theory of multidimensional sovereign capability convergence for a twelve-State international system. The theory begins from the proposition that national capability is not a scalar quantity and cannot be adequately represented by military expenditure, gross domestic product, nuclear weapons, or any other single indicator. Instead, sovereign capability is represented as a twelve-dimensional vector encompassing nuclear-strategic capability, military capability, economic capability, financial capability, technological capability, industrial capability, resource capability, human capability, logistical capability, diplomatic capability, artificial-intelligence capability, and societal resilience.

The theory distinguishes five analytically separate objects: sovereign disclosure, observable capability, international connectivity, directional dependency, and systemic criticality. A State may possess high capability without being systemically resilient; a non-nuclear State may possess capabilities whose disruption would generate substantial international cascades; and a highly connected State need not be cooperative with the States to which it is connected. These distinctions motivate a multiplex-network representation of the international system.

The central normative proposition is that an ideal international system should not require exact equality of capabilities. Rather, each State should possess adequate capability across all strategically consequential dimensions, while excessive concentration and dangerous dependency should be reduced. The objective is therefore capability convergence within an admissible capability corridor rather than forced uniformity.

The paper defines capability floors, capability ceilings, convergence indices, capability-deficit indices, concentration measures, resilience functions, substitution coefficients, systemic bottleneck indices, cascade thresholds, and a Twelve-State Systemic Stability Index. The Standard Nuclear oliGARCHy (SNoG) is interpreted as a specialized catastrophic-risk layer embedded within the larger multidimensional capability system. The paper concludes that sustainable peace is better represented as resilient multidimensional interdependence than as a simple balance of power.

The paper ends with “The End”

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1 Introduction

International relations is frequently described through scalar measures of power. Gross domestic product, military expenditure, population, nuclear arsenals, technological output, financial assets, or diplomatic influence are each sometimes treated as proxies for national strength.

Such representations are useful, but incomplete.

A State does not possess one capability. It possesses a vector of capabilities.

A State may possess substantial military power while remaining financially fragile. Another may possess relatively modest military capability but exceptional financial, technological, logistical, or industrial significance. A third may have no nuclear weapons but occupy a critical position in a global supply chain. A fourth may be geographically small while possessing financial or technological capabilities whose disruption would produce international consequences.

The central proposition of this paper is therefore:

Sovereign capability is intrinsically multidimensional.

Let State i possess the capability vector

$$\mathbf{C}_i = (C_i^N, C_i^M, C_i^E, C_i^F, C_i^T, C_i^I, C_i^R, C_i^H, C_i^L, C_i^D, C_i^A, C_i^S).$$

The twelve dimensions are:

1. N : nuclear and strategic capability;
2. M : military and conventional-security capability;
3. E : economic capability;
4. F : financial capability;
5. T : technological capability;
6. I : industrial capability;
7. R : resource and energy capability;
8. H : human capability;
9. L : logistical and infrastructure capability;
10. D : diplomatic and institutional capability;
11. A : artificial-intelligence and advanced-computation capability;
12. S : societal resilience.

The purpose of the theory is not to make all twelve dimensions identical across States. Exact equality would neither be realistic nor necessarily desirable. The objective is instead to ensure that no State falls below a strategically dangerous capability floor and that no strategically consequential capability becomes so concentrated that the resulting dependency creates systemic fragility.

The resulting objective is:

$$\boxed{\text{capability adequacy} + \frac{\text{reasonable}}{\text{convergence}} + \text{resilience} + \text{substitutability} - \frac{\text{dangerous}}{\text{concentration}}}.$$

This paper formalizes that proposition.

2 The Twelve-State System

Let the set of States be

$$\mathcal{V} = \{US, RU, UK, FR, CN, IN, PK, KP, IL, CH, BE, TW\}.$$

The nine nuclear-armed States are represented by

$$\mathcal{N} = \{US, RU, UK, FR, CN, IN, PK, KP, IL\},$$

while the three additional States are

$$\mathcal{X} = \{CH, BE, TW\}.$$

The inclusion of Switzerland, Belgium, and Taiwan is deliberate. The purpose of the system is not to classify nuclear powers alone, but to recognize capabilities whose international significance may arise through financial, technological, logistical, industrial, diplomatic, or societal channels.

The resulting system is therefore:

$$|\mathcal{V}| = 12, \quad |\mathcal{N}| = 9, \quad |\mathcal{X}| = 3.$$

There are

$$\binom{12}{2} = 66$$

unordered bilateral State pairs.

Because each pair may be connected through twelve capability dimensions, the complete undirected capability-connectivity system contains up to

$$66 \times 12 = 792$$

bilateral capability edges.

The corresponding directed system contains

$$12(12 - 1) \times 12 = 1584$$

potential directional capability relationships.

This immediately demonstrates why a scalar conception of power is insufficient.

3 The Twelve Capability Dimensions

3.1 Nuclear and Strategic Capability

N represents nuclear weapons, strategic deterrence, strategic delivery systems, nuclear command-and-control, strategic early warning, and related crisis-stability capabilities.

The nuclear dimension is special because its consequences are highly nonlinear.

A marginal increase in an ordinary productive capability need not produce a catastrophic consequence. A marginal change in nuclear alert status, strategic ambiguity, command-and-control reliability, or crisis communication can produce a disproportionately large change in systemic risk.

Accordingly,

$N_i \neq$ simply the number of nuclear weapons possessed by State i .

Rather,

$N_i = f(\text{arsenal, delivery, survivability, command, doctrine, alert, communication, crisis stability})$.

3.2 Military Capability

M includes conventional armed forces, defence-industrial capacity, operational readiness, logistics, intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance, cyber capabilities, and military mobilization.

3.3 Economic Capability

E represents productive capacity, income, trade, macroeconomic strength, domestic markets, fiscal resources, and the ability to generate material output.

3.4 Financial Capability

F represents financial-system depth, banking capacity, capital markets, payment systems, reserve assets, liquidity, and financial infrastructure.

3.5 Technological Capability

T represents science, engineering, advanced technologies, research capacity, intellectual property, and technological sophistication.

3.6 Industrial Capability

I represents manufacturing, production systems, industrial supply chains, machinery, advanced manufacturing, and strategic industrial capacity.

3.7 Resource Capability

R represents energy, minerals, food, water, strategic reserves, and access to essential natural resources.

3.8 Human Capability

H represents education, health, human capital, demographic capacity, skilled labour, and institutional ability to develop and reproduce knowledge.

3.9 Logistical Capability

L represents ports, roads, railways, airports, telecommunications, electricity, pipelines, supply-chain infrastructure, and the ability to move physical and informational resources.

3.10 Diplomatic Capability

D represents diplomatic networks, international institutions, negotiation capacity, crisis communication, treaty systems, mediation capability, and the ability to maintain relationships across political divides.

3.11 Artificial-Intelligence Capability

A represents artificial intelligence, advanced computation, data infrastructure, high-performance computing, machine-learning research, autonomous systems, and associated human and industrial ecosystems.

3.12 Societal Resilience

S represents social cohesion, institutional continuity, disaster preparedness, redundancy, public adaptability, emergency response, and the ability of society to absorb shocks without systemic breakdown.

4 Capability as a Vector

Definition 4.1 (Sovereign Capability Vector). *The sovereign capability vector of State i is*

$$\mathbf{C}_i = (C_i^N, C_i^M, C_i^E, C_i^F, C_i^T, C_i^I, C_i^R, C_i^H, C_i^L, C_i^D, C_i^A, C_i^S).$$

Let

$$\mathcal{C} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{12}$$

be the feasible capability space.

The international system is therefore represented by

$$\mathbf{C} = (\mathbf{C}_1, \dots, \mathbf{C}_{12}) \in \mathcal{C}^{12}.$$

The traditional scalar-power representation

$$P_i \in \mathbb{R}$$

is therefore replaced by

$$\mathbf{C}_i \in \mathbb{R}^{12}.$$

Proposition 4.1 (Non-Equivalence of Scalar Power and Sovereign Capability). *No scalar function $P_i = f(\mathbf{C}_i)$ can, in general, preserve all information relevant to systemic capability, dependency, resilience, and cascade risk.*

Proof. Let two States possess vectors $\mathbf{C}_i$ and $\mathbf{C}_j$ with different component structures but identical scalar aggregates under some function f . Since their capability distributions differ, their dependencies, substitutes, vulnerabilities, and cascade effects can also differ. Therefore $f(\mathbf{C}_i) = f(\mathbf{C}_j)$ does not imply equivalence of systemic consequences. Hence no scalar representation can generally preserve the full multidimensional structure. $\square$

5 Sovereign Disclosure and Observable Evidence

A central methodological distinction is required.

Let

$$\mathbf{D}_i$$

denote information voluntarily disclosed by the sovereign authorities of State i .

Let

$$\mathbf{O}_i$$

denote information independently observable from public evidence.

Then:

$$\boxed{\mathbf{D}_i \neq \mathbf{O}_i.}$$

A State may possess capabilities that it does not disclose. Conversely, external observers may infer capabilities that the State itself has not formally recognized.

The Charter therefore maintains three epistemic categories:

1. **Sovereign disclosure:** information voluntarily supplied by an authorized State authority;
2. **Public observation:** independently documented information;

3. **Analytical recognition:** conclusions derived from evidence.

No analytical inference should be represented as a sovereign disclosure.

This distinction is particularly important for nuclear and strategic capabilities.

6 Observable Capability Connectivity

Let

$$O_{ijk}$$

denote the observable connectivity between States i and j through capability dimension k .

For an initial coding,

$$O_{ijk} \in \{0, 1, 2, 3, U\},$$

where U denotes insufficient evidence.

The values 0, 1, 2, 3 represent respectively:

- 0 no material relationship established;
- 1 limited relationship;
- 2 substantial recurring relationship;
- 3 deep or strategically consequential relationship.

For symmetric connectivity,

$$O_{ijk} = O_{jik}.$$

However, connectivity does not imply cooperation.

Definition 6.1 (Interaction Character). *Let*

$$X_{ijk} \in [-1, 1]$$

denote the cooperative or competitive character of the relationship in capability dimension k .

Thus:

$$O_{ijk} > 0$$

does not imply

$$X_{ijk} > 0.$$

A relationship can be simultaneously highly connected and highly competitive.

7 Directional Dependency

Connectivity is distinct from dependency.

Let

$$P_{ij}^{(k)}$$

denote the directional dependence of State i upon State j in capability dimension k .

In general,

$$P_{ij}^{(k)} \neq P_{ji}^{(k)}.$$

This permits:

$$O_{ijk} = O_{jik}$$

while

$$P_{ij}^{(k)} \gg P_{ji}^{(k)}.$$

The distinction is fundamental.

Proposition 7.1 (Connectivity–Dependency Separation). *A symmetric relationship can contain asymmetric strategic dependence.*

Proof. Connectivity measures the existence and breadth of a relationship, whereas dependency measures the relative consequences of losing that relationship. If State i can easily replace State j but State j cannot easily replace State i , then the relationship is symmetric in existence but asymmetric in dependency. $\square$

8 Capability Floors and Ceilings

For each capability k , define a minimum adequate level

$$L_k$$

and a systemic concentration threshold

$$U_k.$$

The admissible capability corridor is

$$L_k \leq C_{ik} \leq U_k.$$

The global admissible region is

$$\mathcal{C}^* = \prod_{k=1}^{12} [L_k, U_k].$$

The capability floor prevents structural incapacity.

The upper threshold is not necessarily a prohibition. It represents the point beyond which excessive concentration may generate systemic dependence, coercive leverage, or instability.

Thus the theory does not seek either:

$$C_{ik} \rightarrow 0$$

or

$$C_{ik} \rightarrow \infty.$$

It seeks:

$$\boxed{C_{ik} \in [L_k, U_k].}$$

9 The Ideal World

The ideal world is not defined by exact equality.

Let

$$\mathbf{C}^* = (C_N^*, C_M^*, \dots, C_S^*)$$

be an ideal reference vector.

The naïve ideal would be

$$\mathbf{C}_1 = \dots = \mathbf{C}_{12} = \mathbf{C}^*.$$

This is unnecessarily restrictive.

The more useful condition is

$$\boxed{\mathbf{C}_i \approx \mathbf{C}_j}$$

subject to geographical, demographic, historical, institutional, and resource constraints. The ideal world therefore satisfies:

$$L_k \leq C_{ik} \leq U_k$$

for all i, k , with reasonable cross-State similarity.

Definition 9.1 (Multidimensional Sovereign Capability Convergence). *Multidimensional sovereign capability convergence is the process through which States approach adequate and reasonably similar capability levels across strategically consequential dimensions while preserving legitimate national differences and reducing dangerous concentration and dependency.*

10 Capability Dispersion

For capability k , define the cross-State mean:

$$\bar{C}_k = \frac{1}{12} \sum_{i=1}^{12} C_{ik}.$$

Define the cross-State standard deviation:

$$\sigma_k = \sqrt{\frac{1}{12} \sum_{i=1}^{12} (C_{ik} - \bar{C}_k)^2}.$$

The dispersion vector is

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma} = (\sigma_N, \sigma_M, \dots, \sigma_S).$$

The ideal convergence condition is:

$$\sigma_k \rightarrow 0.$$

Exact zero is not required. Instead, define an acceptable dispersion threshold:

$$\sigma_k \leq \sigma_k^*.$$

11 Capability Deficit

Define the capability deficit:

$$\Delta_{ik} = \max(0, L_k - C_{ik}).$$

The aggregate Capability Deficit Index is

$$CDI = \frac{1}{144} \sum_{i=1}^{12} \sum_{k=1}^{12} \Delta_{ik}.$$

The ideal condition is:

$$\boxed{CDI = 0.}$$

A State may therefore differ from other States without being systemically deficient. This distinction is important.

Proposition 11.1 (Adequacy Dominates Exact Equality). *If all States satisfy*

$$C_{ik} \geq L_k,$$

then exact equality is unnecessary for preventing capability deprivation.

12 Normalized Capability

Define the normalized capability

$$x_{ik} = \frac{C_{ik} - L_k}{U_k - L_k}.$$

Then

$$x_{ik} \in [0, 1].$$

The normalized mean is

$$\bar{x}_k = \frac{1}{12} \sum_i x_{ik}.$$

Define normalized dispersion:

$$D_k = \sqrt{\frac{1}{12} \sum_i (x_{ik} - \bar{x}_k)^2}.$$

13 Capability Convergence Index

Let

$$w_k \geq 0, \quad \sum_{k=1}^{12} w_k = 1.$$

Define

$$CCI = 1 - \sum_{k=1}^{12} w_k D_k.$$

Then:

$$CCI \in [0, 1]$$

under the chosen normalization.

Higher CCI indicates greater multidimensional convergence.

The index should never be interpreted independently of the underlying vector:

CCI is a summary, not a substitute for the capability matrix.

14 Capability Concentration

For each capability k , define

$$G_k = \frac{\text{Var}(C_{1k}, \dots, C_{12k})}{\bar{C}_k^2 + \varepsilon},$$

where $\varepsilon > 0$ prevents division by zero.

High G_k indicates concentration.

The system-wide concentration index is

$$G = \sum_{k=1}^{12} w_k G_k.$$

The Charter seeks to reduce dangerous concentration without requiring complete equality.

15 Effective Capability

Raw domestic capability does not exhaust effective capability.

Let:

- C_{ik} be domestic capability;
- R_{ik} be resilience;
- S_{ik} be substitution capacity;
- A_{ik} be reliable external access.

Define

$$C_{ik}^{eff} = C_{ik} + \alpha R_{ik} + \beta S_{ik} + \gamma A_{ik},$$

where

$$\alpha, \beta, \gamma \geq 0.$$

A State can therefore possess limited domestic production but high effective capability if reliable alternatives exist.

Conversely, nominally large capability may produce low effective security if it depends upon fragile inputs.

16 Resilience

Resilience is multidimensional.

Define

$$\mathbf{R}_{ik} = (R_{ik}^D, R_{ik}^S, R_{ik}^I, R_{ik}^F, R_{ik}^T, R_{ik}^P),$$

representing:

R^D diversification;

R^S substitutability;

R^I inventories and buffers;

R^F financial capacity;

R^T technical recovery;

R^P policy and institutional response.

Define composite resilience:

$$R_{ik}^* = \sum_m \omega_m R_{ik}^{(m)}, \quad \sum_m \omega_m = 1.$$

Define vulnerability:

$$V_{ik} = C_{ik}(1 - R_{ik}^*).$$

High capability combined with low resilience creates a systemic vulnerability.

17 Substitution and Redundancy

Let

$$n_{ik}$$

denote the number of credible alternative providers of capability k relevant to State i .
A simple redundancy measure is

$$Red_{ik} = 1 - \frac{1}{1 + n_{ik}}.$$

However, numerical alternatives are insufficient. Their capacity must also be considered.
Let Q_{alt} be alternative capacity and Q_{required} the capacity required to replace the disrupted capability.
Then capacity-adjusted substitution is represented by

$$S_{ik}^* = \min \left(1, \frac{Q_{\text{alt}}}{Q_{\text{required}}} \right).$$

A nominal substitute with inadequate capacity is therefore not a full substitute.

18 Time-Dependent Resilience

A substitute available after ten years cannot fully mitigate a shock occurring tomorrow.
Let

$$\tau_{ik}$$

be the replacement time.
A simple recovery function is

$$R_{ik}(t) = 1 - e^{-\lambda_{ik}t}.$$

The parameter λ_{ik} measures the speed of recovery.
Define cumulative resilience loss over horizon T :

$$\mathcal{L}_{ik} = \int_0^T [1 - R_{ik}(t)] dt.$$

Two States can have identical long-run recovery while suffering radically different short-run losses.

19 Systemic Bottlenecks

Define capability uniqueness:

$$U_{ik} \in [0, 1].$$

The systemic bottleneck index is

$$\boxed{\beta_{ik} = C_{ik} U_{ik} (1 - S_{ik}^*)}.$$

High β_{ik} indicates a capability that is:

1. important;
2. difficult to replace;
3. relatively unique.

A systemic bottleneck need not be a hostile vulnerability. It can be a globally valuable capability whose continuity should be protected.

20 Criticality

Let K_{ik} denote systemic criticality.

The simplest interpretation is the loss of network functionality resulting from disruption:

$$K_{ik} = \frac{\Phi(G) - \Phi(G \setminus \{i, k\})}{\Phi(G)},$$

where $\Phi(G)$ is a network-functionality measure.

This gives a counterfactual interpretation:

How much functionality disappears if capability k of State i is removed?

This is more informative than raw capability.

21 Crisis Cascades

Let

$$z_i^k \in \{0, 1\}$$

indicate disruption of capability k in State i .

The first-order consequence to State j is

$$C_{ij}^{(k)}.$$

The total cascade is

$$\mathbf{C}_i = \sum_{j \neq i} \sum_k C_{ij}^{(k)} e_j.$$

Cascades may be:

1. direct;
2. substitution-induced;
3. network-induced;
4. strategic;
5. catastrophic.

The cascade need not be additive.

Define the interaction term:

$$\Gamma_{ij}^{kl} = C_{ij}^{kl} - C_{ij}^k - C_{ij}^l.$$

If

$$\Gamma_{ij}^{kl} > 0,$$

the two disrupted capabilities exhibit superadditive consequences.

22 Multiplex Networks

The international system is represented by twelve capability-specific graphs:

$$G_N, G_M, G_E, G_F, G_T, G_I, G_R, G_H, G_L, G_D, G_A, G_S.$$

The complete multiplex system is

$$G = \bigcup_{k=1}^{12} G_k.$$

The adjacency operator therefore has the form

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} A_N & A_{NM} & \cdots \\ A_{MN} & A_M & \cdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots \end{pmatrix}.$$

The cross-layer matrices A_{kl} represent interactions between capability dimensions. Hence:

$$A \neq \text{diag}(A_N, A_M, \dots, A_S).$$

This non-block-diagonal structure is the mathematical source of multidimensional cascades.

23 Centrality

For capability k , define degree centrality:

$$d_i^{(k)} = \sum_{j \neq i} O_{ijk}.$$

Define aggregate weighted degree:

$$d_i = \sum_k w_k d_i^{(k)}.$$

Betweenness centrality is

$$BC_i = \sum_{s \neq i \neq t} \frac{\sigma_{st}(i)}{\sigma_{st}},$$

where σ_{st} is the number of shortest paths between s and t and $\sigma_{st}(i)$ is the number passing through i .

Multiplex betweenness is represented by

$$\mathbf{BC}_i = (BC_i^N, \dots, BC_i^S).$$

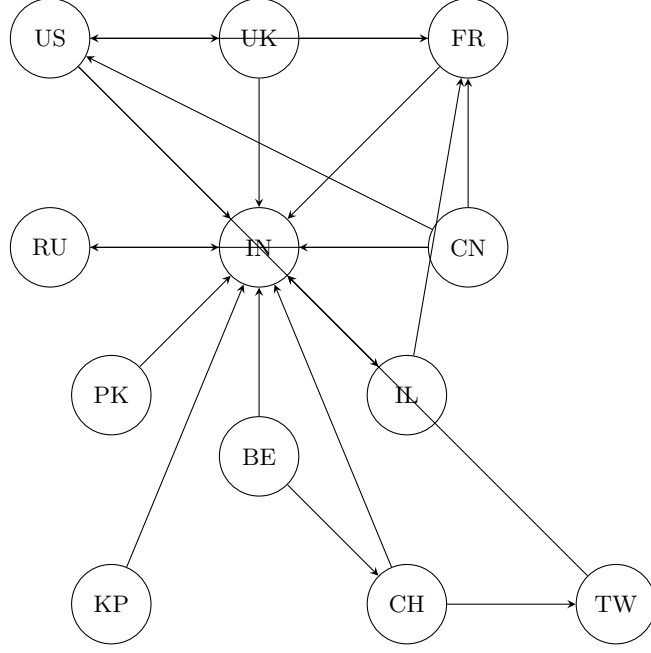
A State may therefore be central in one network and peripheral in another.

24 The Twelve-State Capability Network

A schematic representation is shown below.

The figure is intentionally schematic. The actual analytical object is the multiplex adjacency tensor

$$\mathcal{O}_{ijk}.$$



25 India as a Candidate Multiplex Bridge

The observable network suggests that India is a candidate bridge node.
Its relationships extend simultaneously into:

North America, Europe, Russia, China, South Asia, Israel, Switzerland, Belgium, Taiwan.

The hypothesis is therefore not simply that India has high degree.
It is:

$BC_{IN}^{multiplex}$ is potentially high because India's edges occupy heterogeneous capability layers.

This must remain an empirical hypothesis until all bilateral edges are documented symmetrically.

26 The Ideal Capability Corridor

The ideal world is represented by

$$\mathcal{W}^* = \{\mathbf{C}_1, \dots, \mathbf{C}_{12} : L_k \leq C_{ik} \leq U_k\}.$$

The objective is not exact equality but convergence toward this region.
Define corridor distance:

$$d_i^{corr} = \sqrt{\sum_k w_k [\max(0, L_k - C_{ik})^2 + \max(0, C_{ik} - U_k)^2]}.$$

The system-wide corridor distance is

$$D^{corr} = \frac{1}{12} \sum_i d_i^{corr}.$$

The ideal condition is:

$$D^{corr} \rightarrow 0.$$

27 The Principle of Non-Coercive Convergence

Capability convergence must not be achieved by coercively reducing States to a common denominator. Instead, convergence should occur through:

- peaceful economic development;
- technological diffusion;
- education;
- infrastructure investment;
- institutional development;
- diversified supply chains;
- financial resilience;
- scientific cooperation;
- diplomatic engagement;
- defensive stability;
- crisis-management mechanisms.

The principle is:

Raise capability deficits rather than deliberately creating capability deficits elsewhere.

28 The Special Status of Nuclear Capability

The nuclear dimension cannot be treated identically to the other eleven dimensions.

For ordinary capabilities, convergence may imply:

$$C_{ik} \uparrow$$

for deficient States.

For nuclear weapons, simple numerical convergence would be destabilizing.

The appropriate objective is:

security $\rightarrow$ stability $\rightarrow$ risk reduction $\rightarrow$ arms reduction.

Thus the nuclear dimension should be evaluated through:

$$N_i = f(\text{deterrence, survivability, command, communication, doctrine, crisis stability}).$$

The ultimate nuclear objective is not equal nuclear capability, but declining catastrophic risk.

29 The Standard Nuclear oliGARCHy as a Subsystem

The Standard Nuclear oliGARCHy (SNoG) is interpreted in this theory as a specialized representation of the nuclear-risk subsystem.

Symbolically,

$$G_N \subset G.$$

The broader Charter does not replace the SNoG.

Rather,

$$\text{Twelve-State Charter} = \text{SNoG} + \text{eleven additional capability layers} + \text{cross-layer interactions}.$$

The SNoG addresses the catastrophic nuclear tail, while the broader framework addresses the multi-dimensional system surrounding it.

30 The Systemic Stability Index

Let:

$$CCI = \text{capability convergence}, \quad (1)$$

$$CDI = \text{capability deprivation}, \quad (2)$$

$$G = \text{capability concentration}, \quad (3)$$

$$V = \text{systemic vulnerability}, \quad (4)$$

$$\mathcal{C} = \text{cascade potential}, \quad (5)$$

$$N_R = \text{nuclear catastrophic risk}, \quad (6)$$

$$D = \text{diplomatic buffering}. \quad (7)$$

Define a provisional Twelve-State Systemic Stability Index:

$$SSI = \lambda_1 CCI - \lambda_2 CDI - \lambda_3 G - \lambda_4 V - \lambda_5 \mathcal{C} - \lambda_6 N_R + \lambda_7 D,$$

where

$$\lambda_j \geq 0.$$

Higher SSI represents greater systemic stability.

The weights should be estimated, justified, or stress-tested rather than arbitrarily fixed.

31 The Cascade Threshold

Let the system evolve according to

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = A(\mathbf{x}_t)\mathbf{x}_t + B\mathbf{u}_t + \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_t.$$

Let $\rho(A)$ be the spectral radius.

Define the stability margin:

$$SM = 1 - \rho(A).$$

Then:

$$SM > 0$$

represents a locally dissipative regime, whereas

$$SM < 0$$

represents a potentially amplifying regime.

The critical boundary is:

$$\boxed{\rho(A) = 1.}$$

The Charter therefore seeks policies that increase SM .

32 Diplomatic Capability as Negative Feedback

Diplomatic capability can reduce escalation.

Let escalation risk be

$$E_R.$$

Under appropriate conditions,

$$\frac{\partial E_R}{\partial D} < 0.$$

Therefore diplomatic capacity is not merely another positive capability.
It can operate as a stabilizing feedback mechanism:

$$D \uparrow \implies E_R \downarrow.$$

This is especially important when military or nuclear capabilities are already high.

33 Systemic Criticality and Resilience

Define systemic criticality:

$$K_{ik} = \frac{\Phi(G) - \Phi(G \setminus \{i, k\})}{\Phi(G)}.$$

Define resilience:

$$R_{ik} \in [0, 1].$$

Then systemic fragility can be represented as

$$F_{ik} = K_{ik}(1 - R_{ik}).$$

The most important cells are those for which

$$K_{ik} \gg 0, \quad R_{ik} \ll 1.$$

These are the *Systemic Fragility Cells*.
Conversely,

$$K_{ik} \gg 0, \quad R_{ik} \gg 0$$

defines a *Systemic Backbone Cell*.

34 Resilient Interdependence

The ideal international system is not autarkic.

Autarky eliminates some dependencies but also destroys beneficial specialization and cooperation.
The alternative is resilient interdependence:

high connectivity + low catastrophic dependence + high substitutability + credible communication.

A system can therefore maximize beneficial trade while minimizing existential dependence.
This produces the principle:

No State should be indispensable to the survival of another, while every State should be valuable to the survival and prosperity of the system.

35 The Sovereign Capability Recognition Charter

The Charter should establish the following principles.

1. Every State possesses multidimensional sovereign capabilities.
2. No State's capability should be reduced to a scalar power ranking.
3. Sovereign disclosure must be distinguished from external observation.
4. Publicly observable relationships should be documented without being misrepresented as sovereign disclosures.
5. Capability connectivity must be distinguished from cooperation.

6. Connectivity must be distinguished from directional dependency.
7. Criticality must be distinguished from capability magnitude.
8. Resilience and substitutability must be measured separately from capability.
9. Strategically consequential capability deficits should be reduced peacefully.
10. Dangerous capability concentration should be reduced through diversification and resilience.
11. Nuclear capability requires special treatment because of its nonlinear catastrophic consequences.
12. Diplomatic capability should be recognized as a stabilizing capability.
13. Non-nuclear States may possess systemically critical capabilities.
14. Capability convergence should be developmental and non-coercive.
15. The ultimate objective is resilient multidimensional interdependence.

36 Policy Architecture

The policy mechanism can be represented as

Recognition → Measurement → $\begin{matrix} \text{Gap} \\ \text{Identification} \end{matrix}$ → $\begin{matrix} \text{Capacity} \\ \text{Building} \end{matrix}$ → Diversification → Resilience → Stability.

The practical interventions include:

- development assistance;
- technology partnerships;
- educational exchanges;
- infrastructure investment;
- supply-chain diversification;
- strategic reserves;
- financial backstops;
- scientific cooperation;
- emergency communications;
- diplomatic hotlines;
- crisis-management institutions;
- peaceful industrial development;
- transparent capability recognition.

37 A Dynamic Convergence Model

Let capability evolve according to

$$C_{ik,t+1} = C_{ik,t} + I_{ik,t} - D_{ik,t} + T_{ik,t} + R_{ik,t},$$

where:

- $I_{ik,t}$ is domestic investment;
- $D_{ik,t}$ is depreciation or disruption;
- $T_{ik,t}$ is technological transfer;
- $R_{ik,t}$ is resilience-enhancing investment.

The capability gap is

$$\Delta_{ik,t} = L_k - C_{ik,t}.$$

A convergence policy increases investment when:

$$\Delta_{ik,t} > 0.$$

Thus:

$$I_{ik,t} = I_{ik,t}^0 + \eta_k \max(0, \Delta_{ik,t}).$$

The coefficient η_k measures the strength of convergence investment.

38 Optimal Control Interpretation

Let $\mathbf{u}_t$ contain policy interventions.

The system evolves according to

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = F(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{u}_t, \epsilon_t).$$

The policymaker minimizes expected discounted systemic loss:

$$\min_{\{\mathbf{u}_t\}} \mathbb{E} \left[\sum_{t=0}^T \delta^t L(\mathbf{x}_t) \right].$$

The loss function may be written:

$$L = \theta_1 CDI + \theta_2 G + \theta_3 V + \theta_4 \mathcal{C} + \theta_5 N_R - \theta_6 D.$$

This creates a stochastic optimal-control interpretation of international stability.

39 Why Exact Equality Is Not the Objective

Exact equality can be undesirable for several reasons.

First, comparative advantage produces legitimate specialization.

Second, geography creates unavoidable resource differences.

Third, population size changes economically optimal scales.

Fourth, institutional structures differ.

Fifth, technological specialization may benefit all States.

The objective is therefore:

$$\text{similar adequacy, not identical structure.}$$

A small State can remain small.

A resource-rich State can remain resource-rich.

A technological State can remain technologically specialized.
What should be avoided is a situation in which:

$$C_{ik} \ll L_k$$

or

$$P_{ij}^{(k)} \rightarrow 1$$

for a strategically consequential capability.

40 Theoretical Propositions

Proposition 40.1 (Multidimensionality). *Systemic national capability cannot generally be represented without loss by a scalar measure.*

Proposition 40.2 (Adequacy). *A system in which all States satisfy capability floors is less vulnerable to coercive dependency than a system containing severe capability deficits, ceteris paribus.*

Proposition 40.3 (Concentration). *For strategically consequential capabilities, excessive concentration increases systemic vulnerability when substitution capacity is limited.*

Proposition 40.4 (Resilience). *For fixed capability and connectivity, increasing substitution, redundancy, buffers, and recovery speed reduces expected systemic disruption.*

Proposition 40.5 (Diplomatic Buffer). *For fixed military capability, credible diplomatic connectivity can reduce escalation probability when communication reduces uncertainty and permits negotiated de-escalation.*

Proposition 40.6 (Nuclear Non-Equivalence). *Numerical equality of nuclear capabilities is neither necessary nor sufficient for systemic nuclear stability.*

Proposition 40.7 (Resilient Interdependence). *An international system can increase economic and technological interdependence while reducing systemic vulnerability if diversification and substitution increase sufficiently.*

41 Proof Sketch of the Convergence Principle

Suppose the capability-deficit dynamics are

$$\Delta_{ik,t+1} = (1 - \eta_k) \Delta_{ik,t},$$

where

$$0 < \eta_k < 1.$$

Then:

$$\Delta_{ik,t} = (1 - \eta_k)^t \Delta_{ik,0}.$$

Since

$$0 < 1 - \eta_k < 1,$$

we obtain

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \Delta_{ik,t} = 0.$$

Therefore, under sustained positive convergence investment and absent sufficiently large adverse shocks, capability deficits converge toward zero.

This establishes the basic mathematical intuition behind peaceful capability convergence.

42 The Ideal-World Condition

The ideal world is therefore characterized by:

$C_{ik} \geq L_k$	$\forall i, k,$
$R_{ik} \geq R_k^{min}$	$\forall i, k,$
$P_{ij}^{(k)} \leq P_k^{max}$	$\forall i \neq j, k,$
$G_k \rightarrow 0$	$\forall k,$
$CDI \rightarrow 0,$	
$CCI \rightarrow 1,$	
$SM > 0,$	
$N_R \rightarrow 0.$	

The final condition does not require instantaneous nuclear disarmament. It represents the long-run objective of reducing catastrophic nuclear risk.

43 Interpretation

The theory produces a different conception of international equality.

Traditional equality asks whether States possess equal quantities.

Multidimensional capability convergence asks whether States possess sufficient and reasonably comparable ability to:

1. protect themselves;
2. produce;
3. finance;
4. innovate;
5. manufacture;
6. obtain resources;
7. develop human capital;
8. operate infrastructure;
9. negotiate;
10. use advanced computation;
11. withstand shocks.

The distinction can be summarized as:

Equality of quantity $\neq$ equality of sovereign agency.

The latter is the actual objective.

44 Conclusion

This paper has developed a theory of Multidimensional Sovereign Capability Convergence.

Its central proposition is that national capability is a vector rather than a scalar. The twelve dimensions considered are nuclear-strategic, military, economic, financial, technological, industrial, resource, human, logistical, diplomatic, artificial-intelligence, and societal-resilience capabilities.

The theory distinguishes sovereign disclosure from public observation, capability from connectivity, connectivity from cooperation, connectivity from dependency, capability from criticality, and criticality from resilience.

These distinctions permit the international system to be represented as a multiplex network rather than a simple balance-of-power system.

The ideal international system is not one in which every State possesses identical capabilities. Exact equality would be neither feasible nor necessarily desirable. Instead, the ideal is a system in which every State possesses adequate capability across strategically consequential dimensions, dangerous capability deficits are reduced, strategically consequential concentration is moderated, substitutes exist for critical functions, and diplomatic channels remain sufficiently robust to prevent ordinary disputes from becoming catastrophic cascades.

The central objective is therefore:

capability convergence without coercive uniformity.

The resulting normative principle is:

Make every State capable enough that no State needs to dominate another to remain secure.

This principle transforms the meaning of international stability.

Security is no longer merely the absence of attack. It becomes the presence of sufficient sovereign capability, resilient interdependence, credible substitutes, functioning institutions, and mechanisms capable of absorbing shocks.

The SNoG occupies an important but specialized position within this architecture. Nuclear weapons constitute the catastrophic tail of the international capability distribution, but nuclear risk is embedded in a much larger system of economic, technological, financial, industrial, logistical, diplomatic, and societal relationships.

Consequently,

SNoG $\subset$ Twelve-State Capability System.

The ultimate objective of the broader system is:

adequate
capability + reasonable
convergence + resilience + substitutability + diplomatic
buffering $\rightarrow$ systemic
stability.

An ideal world may not exist.

Nevertheless, an ideal direction exists.

The theory developed here provides one mathematical representation of that direction.

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Glossary

Capability Convergence The process through which States approach adequate and reasonably similar capability levels across strategically consequential dimensions.

Capability Corridor The interval $[L_k, U_k]$ within which a capability is regarded as adequate without creating excessive systemic concentration.

Capability Deficit The shortfall of a State's capability below the minimum adequate level.

Capability Floor The minimum capability required for meaningful sovereign agency in a particular dimension.

Capability Vector The twelve-dimensional representation of a State's sovereign capabilities.

Criticality The systemic consequence of removing a capability or State from the network.

Dependency The directional extent to which one State relies upon another capability.

Diplomatic Buffer The stabilizing effect produced by communication, negotiation, mediation, and institutional relationships.

Effective Capability Capability adjusted for resilience, substitution, and reliable external access.

Multiplex Network A network containing multiple simultaneous relationship layers corresponding to distinct capability dimensions.

Resilience The ability to absorb, adapt to, substitute for, and recover from disruption.

Resilient Interdependence A condition of substantial international connectivity without catastrophic dependency.

Systemic Bottleneck A strategically important capability that is highly concentrated and difficult to substitute.

Systemic Fragility The combination of high systemic criticality and low resilience.

Systemic Stability The capacity of the international network to absorb shocks without entering an amplifying or catastrophic regime.

Sovereign Disclosure Capability information voluntarily supplied by an authorized sovereign authority.

Observable Capability Capability information established through independently available evidence.

Substitutability The extent to which alternative providers or mechanisms can replace a disrupted capability.

Twelve-State System The set of nine nuclear-armed States together with Switzerland, Belgium, and Taiwan used as the analytical domain of this paper.

The End